

ABSOLUTE

FLASH



ALL IN

13+
TEEN

1



JEFF
LEMIRE
NICK
ROBLES
ADRIANO
LUCAS

Robles

ALL IN



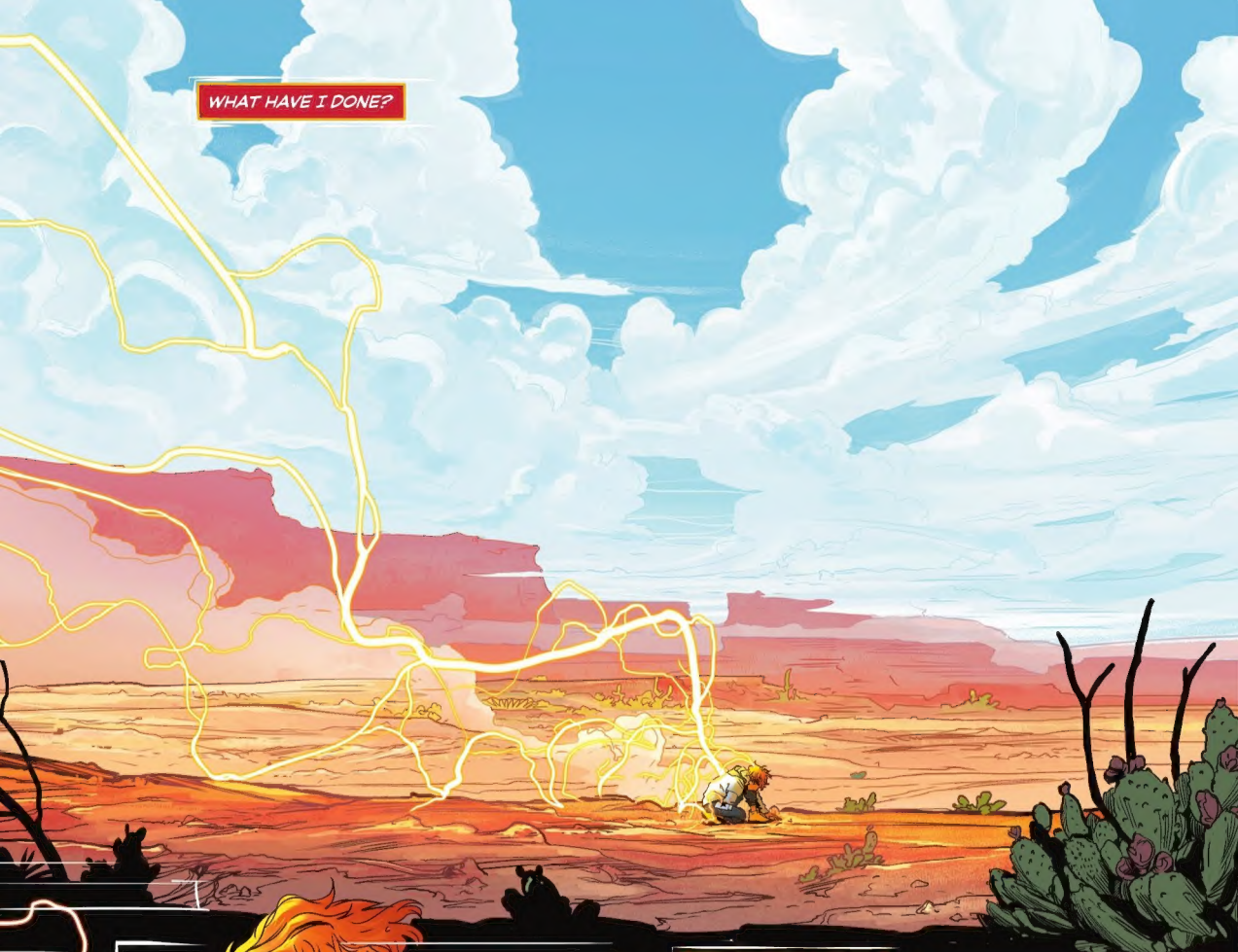
ABSOLUTE



Written by **DENIZ CAMP** • Art and cover by **JAVIER RODRÍGUEZ**

A startling evolution of the Absolute Universe beginning in **MARCH**

WHAT HAVE I DONE?



WHAT HAVE I DONE?

WHAT HAVE I DONE?

WHAT HAVE I DONE?

WHAT HAVE I DONE?



THIS IS ALL
SO MESSED
UP. I'M--

--I'VE RUINED
EVERYTHING. I
CAN'T GO BACK.
I HAVE TO--

--HAVE
TO KEEP
GOING--

--KEEP RUNNING.
WHEN THEY FIND
OUT--

--WHEN HE FINDS
OUT HE'S LITERALLY
GOING TO KILL ME.

BUT WHAT DOES
IT MATTER NOW?

EVERYTHING
IS MESSED UP.

EVERYTHING IS
POINTLESS NOW...

...I--I MESSED
UP SO BAD...





ABSOLUTE
FLASH
IN

**OF TWO
WORLDS**
PART ONE

JEFF LEMIRE WRITER
NICK ROBLES ART AND COVER
ADRIANO LUCAS COLORS
TOM NAPOLITANO LETTERS

**CLAYTON CRAIN, DAN PANOSIAN, JEFF LEMIRE,
DECLAN SHALVEY, RAFAEL ALBUQUERQUE** VARIANT COVERS

ASH PADILLA ASSISTANT EDITOR
MARQUIS DRAPER ASSOCIATE EDITOR
ANDREW MARINO EDITOR

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CHRIS CONROY EXECUTIVE EDITOR



IT'S ALL GOING TOO FAST.
JUST NEED TO BREATHE...

...BREATHE, WALLY, JUST
LIKE SHE TAUGHT YOU...

...BREATHE...

...SLOW IT DOWN...



SLOW.

IT.



--DOWN?

I--

?!

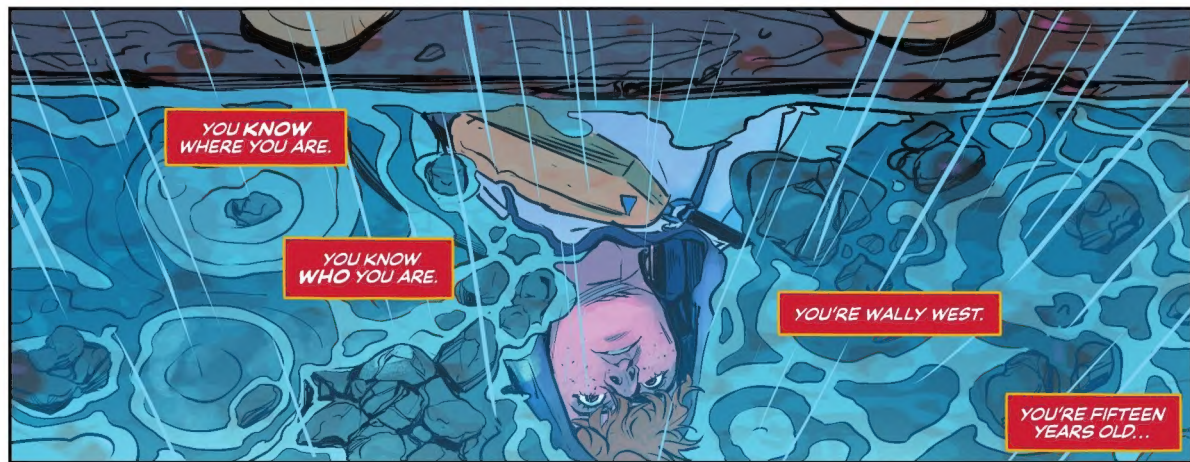


YOU KNOW
WHERE YOU ARE.

YOU KNOW
WHO YOU ARE.

YOU'RE WALLY WEST.

YOU'RE FIFTEEN
YEARS OLD...



...AND YOU ARE COMPLETELY AND TOTALLY ALONE.

I KNEW IT WAS ONLY A MATTER OF TIME. THINGS HAD BEEN OKAY FOR A WHILE, BUT I COULD FEEL IT COMING ON AGAIN...

IT ALWAYS STARTS IN MY STOMACH, LIKE THIS TERRIBLE LOW-LEVEL UNEASY FEELING THAT BEGINS TO SPREAD...

...AND THEN I KNOW IT'S STARTING AGAIN. THE RACING THOUGHTS, OBSSIVE OVERTHINKING.

SHE USED TO CATCH IT EARLY. SHE COULD MAKE ME RELAX. HELP ME CALM DOWN...

BUT SHE'S GONE. IT'S JUST ME NOW.

I DON'T NEED ANYONE ELSE ANYWAY. IN THE END WE'RE ALL ALONE. OTHER PEOPLE JUST MESS EVERYTHING UP.

WHEN IT'S JUST ME, I HAVE CONTROL.

TOTAL CONTROL.



SO BREATHE, WALLY...
JUST BREATHE.



THIS IS A
RESTRICTED
AREA.

YEAH, I HAVE
MY PASS HERE
SOMEWHERE...



YOU KNOW YOU'RE
NOT SUPPOSED
TO BE OUT
THIS LATE,
KID.

**YOUR
DAD CATCHES
YOU, HE'LL
HAVE A FIT.**



AT
EASE.

I CAN
ESCORT THE
PRISONER
FROM
HERE.



CUT THE KID
SOME SLACK,
SERGEANT.

WE
WERE ALL
YOUNG ONCE,
WEREN'T
WE?



THANKS,
DR. ALLEN.

I KEEP
TELLING YOU,
BARRY, PLEASE.
SO, WAS IT
WORTH
IT?

STAYING
OUT PAST
CURFEW? GET
INTO ANY
TROUBLE?

NOT
REALLY.
NOTHING TO
DO AROUND
HERE
ANYWAY.





SO, YOUR DAD TELL YOU ANYTHING ABOUT WHAT WE'RE DOING HERE AT FORT FOX?

UH, NO. NOT REALLY. JUST RESEARCH STUFF.

HE AND I DON'T TALK ABOUT HIS WORK VERY MUCH.

WHAT DO YOU TWO TALK ABOUT?

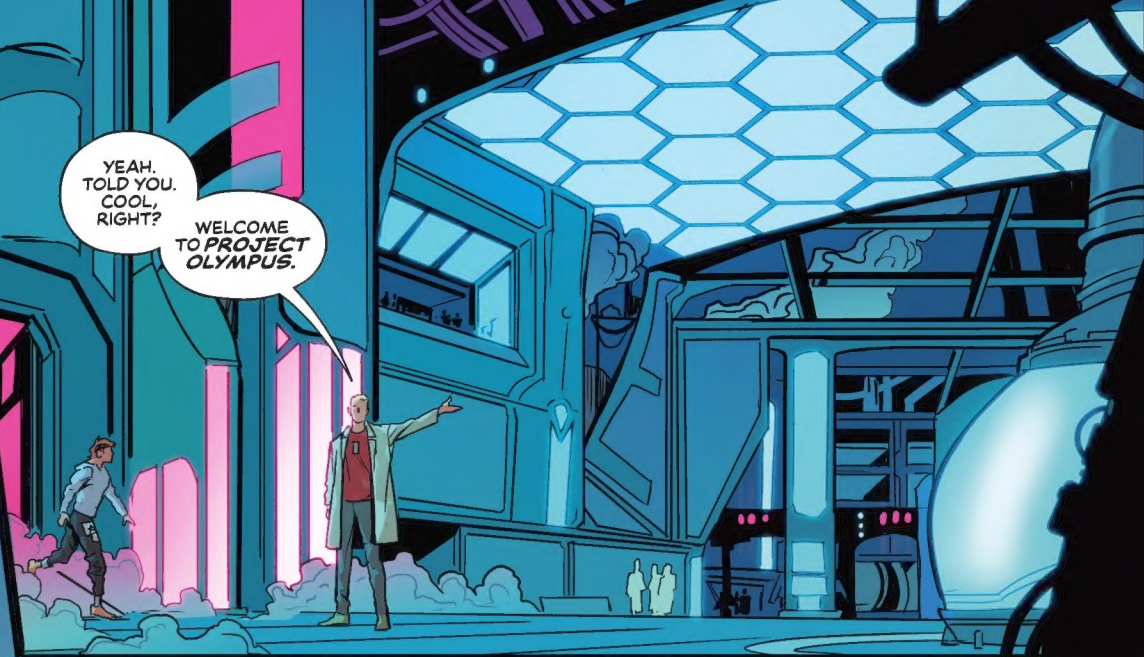
HONESTLY, NOT MUCH.

SINCE MY MOM DIED, HE AND I DON'T REALLY HAVE MUCH IN COMMON.

YEAH. ME AND MY OLD MAN TOO.



WHOA.



YEAH. TOLD YOU. COOL, RIGHT?

WELCOME TO PROJECT OLYMPUS.



WHAT EXACTLY ARE YOU GUYS DOING DOWN HERE?



PROJECT OLYMPUS IS... WELL, I CAN'T TELL YOU EVERYTHING, BUT WE'RE WORKING ON THE VERY RAZOR'S EDGE OF PSYCHICS AND BIOLOGY...

...I MEAN, I'M NOT GOING TO LIE, IT'S THE MILITARY, SO THE MANDATE IS OBVIOUSLY WEAPONS DEVELOPMENT, BUT THAT'S ONLY THE BEGINNING.

WHERE WE CAN GO FROM THERE IS...

...WELL, WE'RE BREAKING NEW GROUND EVERY DAY.



LOOK, I'M GLAD I RAN INTO YOU, WALLY. LIKE I SAID, I READ YOUR FILE. YOU'RE A SMART KID.

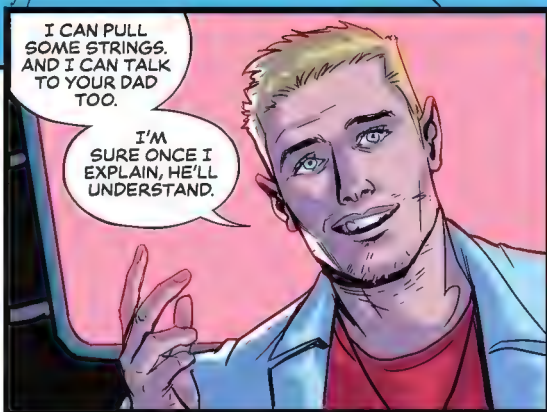
TOO SMART TO BE STUCK SITTING AROUND THE BARRACKS AND GOING TO THAT EMBARRASSMENT THEY CALL A SCHOOL.

MAYBE YOU CAN WORK PART-TIME WITH ME DOWN HERE ONCE IN A WHILE?



OH, UH, I MEAN, THAT WOULD BE AWESOME, BUT MY DAD WOULD **NEVER** LET ME.

BESIDES, ISN'T THIS ALL, LIKE, **SUPER CLASSIFIED?**

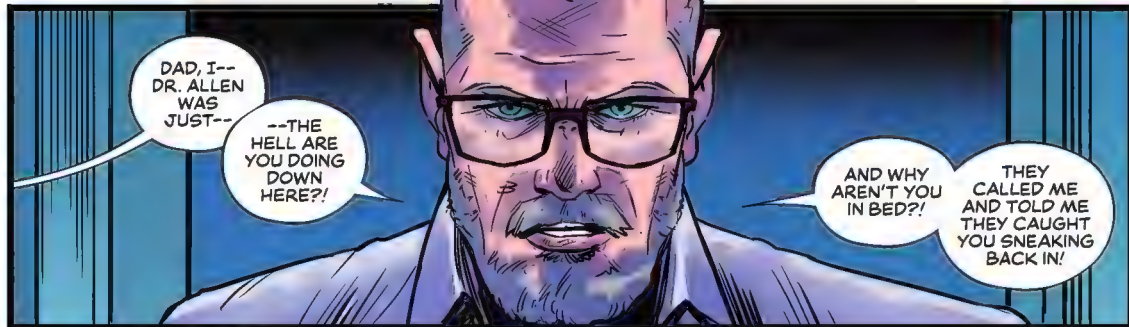


I CAN PULL SOME STRINGS. AND I CAN TALK TO YOUR DAD TOO.

I'M SURE ONCE I EXPLAIN, HE'LL UNDERSTAND.



NO. I **WON'T.**



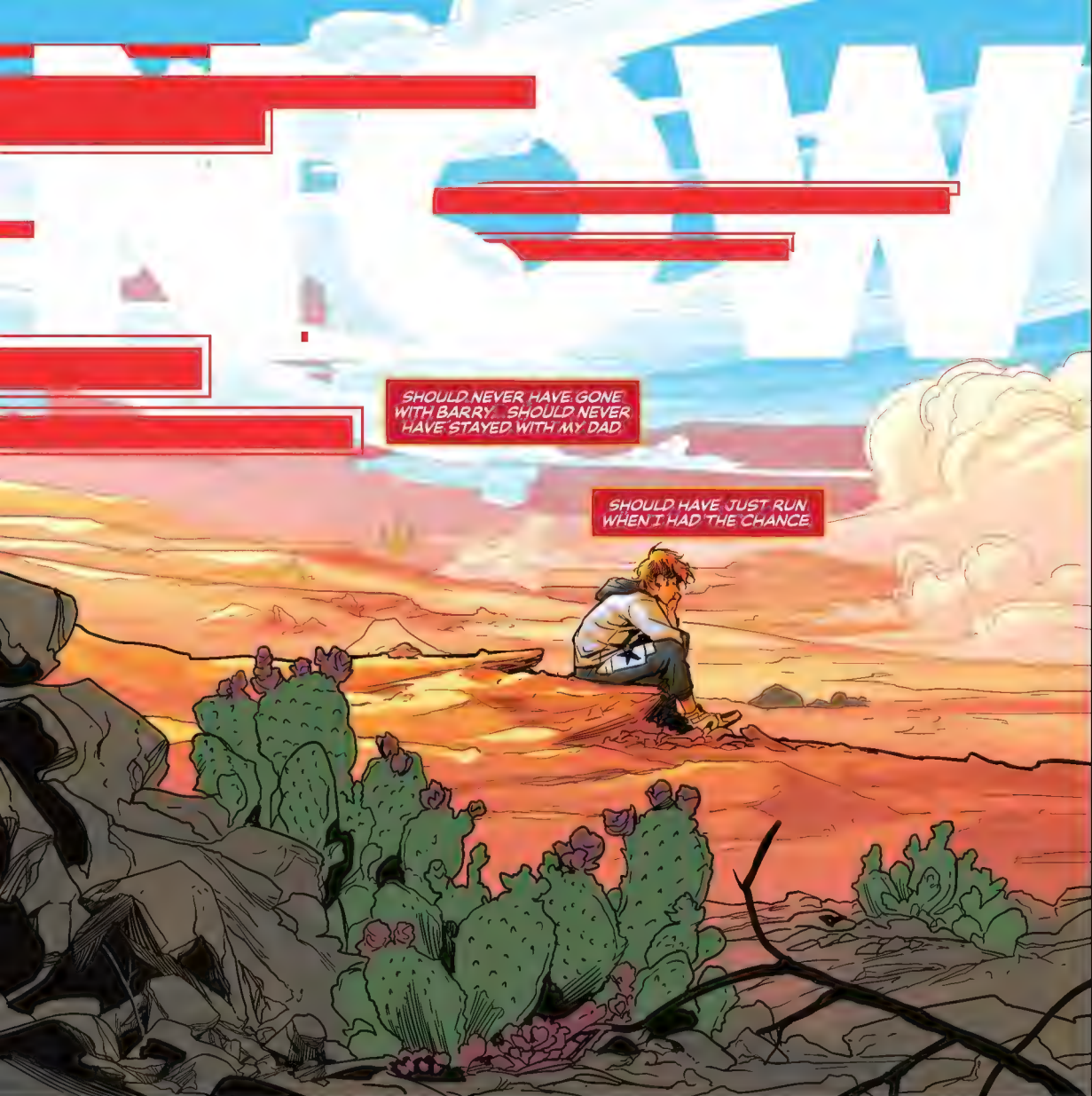
DAD, I-- DR. ALLEN WAS JUST--

--THE HELL ARE YOU DOING DOWN HERE?!

AND WHY AREN'T YOU IN BED?!

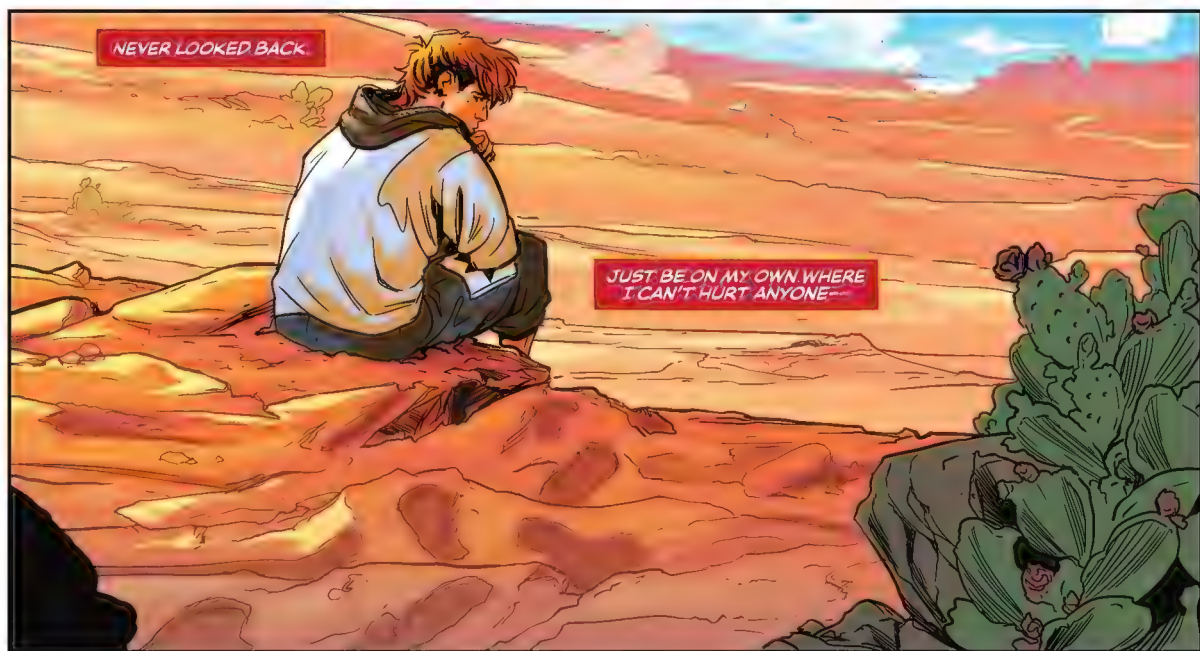
THEY CALLED ME AND TOLD ME THEY CAUGHT YOU SNEAKING BACK IN!





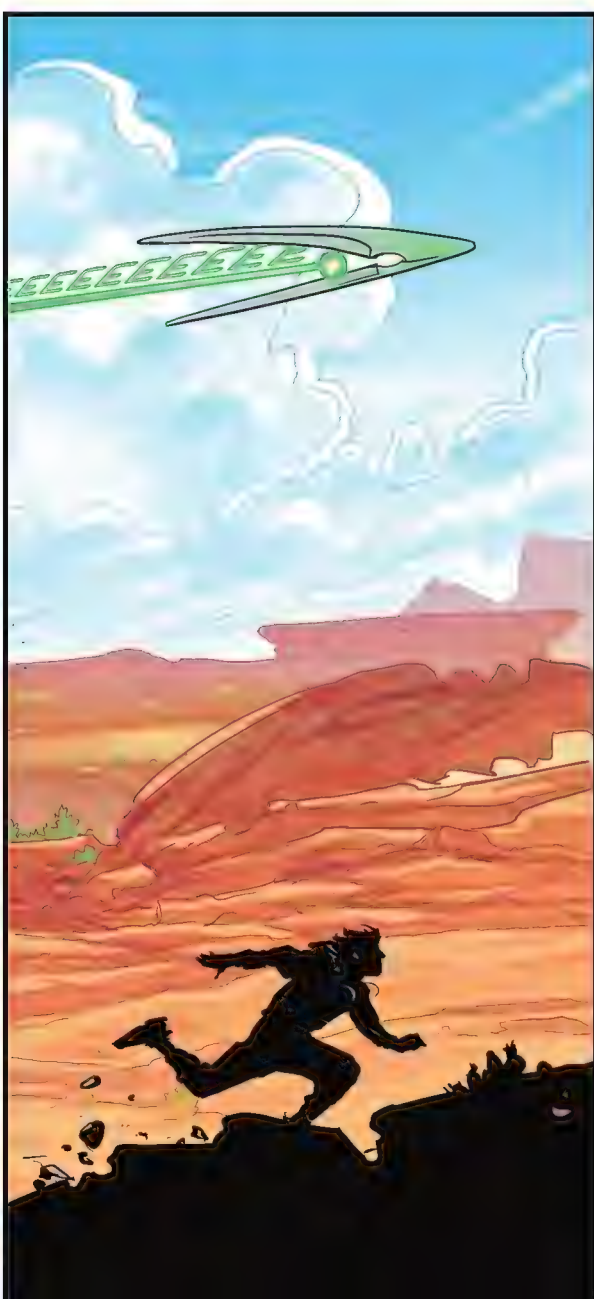
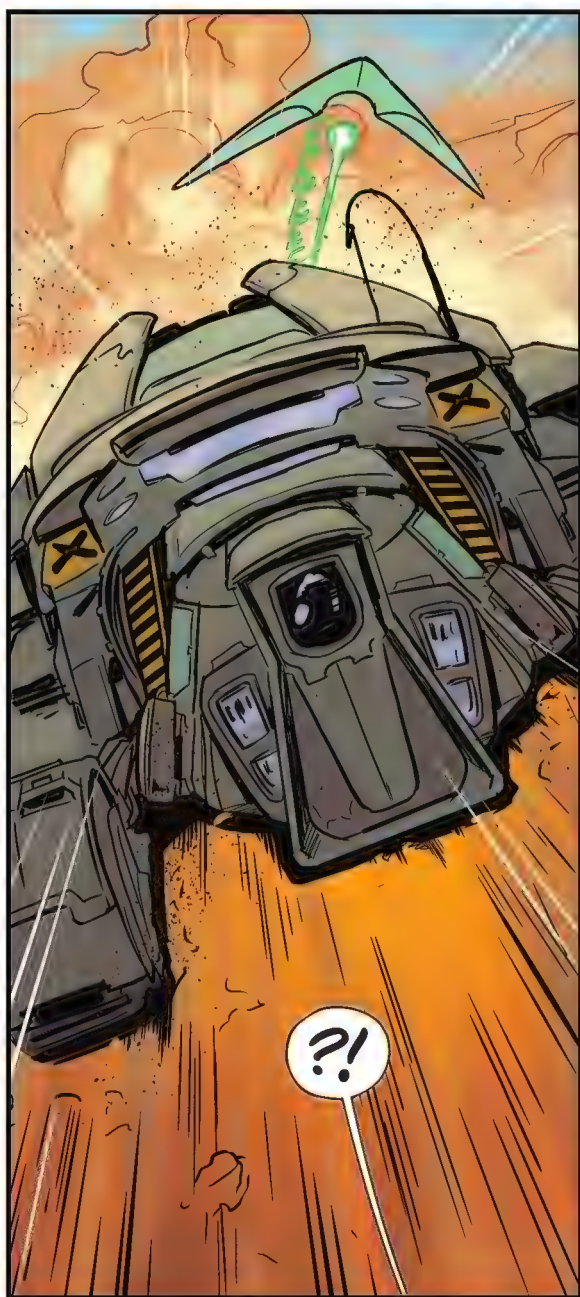
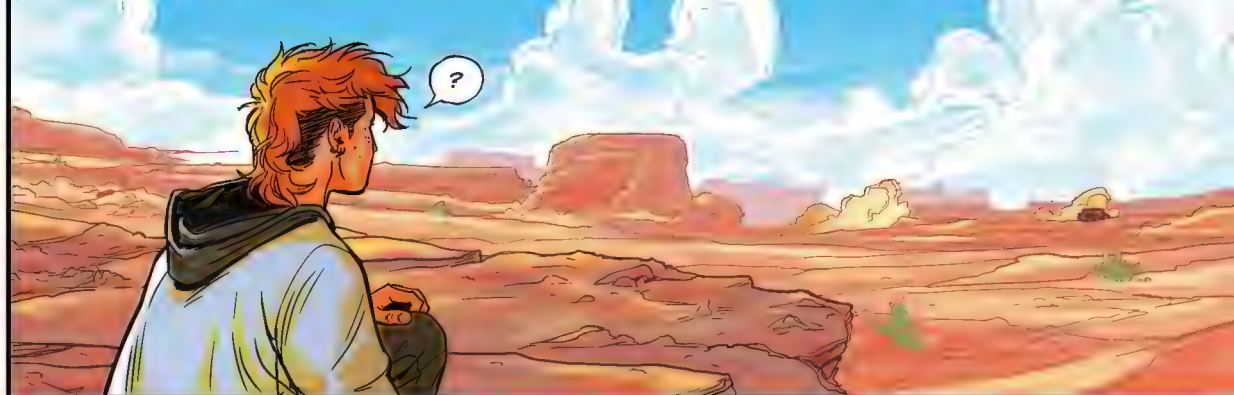
SHOULD NEVER HAVE GONE
WITH BARRY. SHOULD NEVER
HAVE STAYED WITH MY DAD.

SHOULD HAVE JUST RUN
WHEN I HAD THE CHANCE.



NEVER LOOKED BACK.

JUST BE ON MY OWN WHERE
I CAN'T HURT ANYONE—



A wide shot of a desert canyon with a cave entrance. The landscape is arid and rocky, with a large, dark cave opening in the distance. The scene is bathed in warm, orange light, suggesting a sunset or sunrise.

POSITIVE I.D.
WALLACE WEST.
DO I HAVE
PERMISSION TO
ATTACK?

A character with red hair, wearing a white hoodie and dark pants, is running through a desert canyon. He is looking back over his shoulder with a determined expression. In the background, a large, dark cave entrance is visible, and a bright green beam of light emanates from it. The scene is bathed in warm, orange light.

NEGATIVE.
RETURN TO
UNIT.

I COULD HAVE
TAKEN HIM
AND SAVED US
ALL A LOT OF
TROUBLE.

SO...
WHAT'LL
IT BE, THEN,
CAPTAIN?

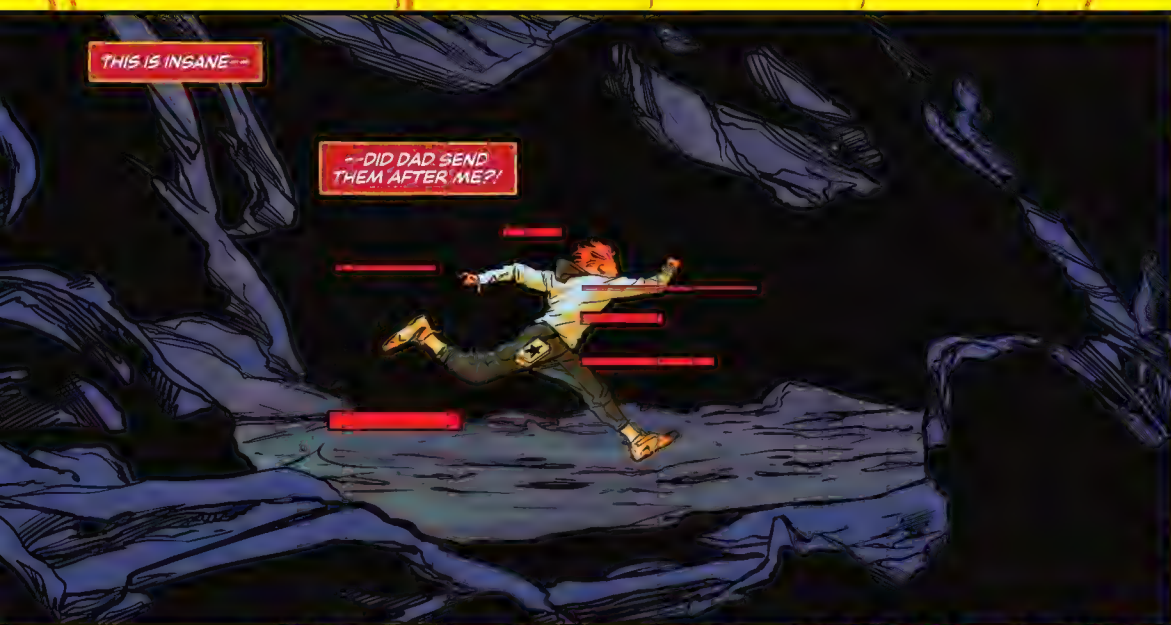
JESSE,
LISA, SPLIT
UP AND
FLANK
HIM.

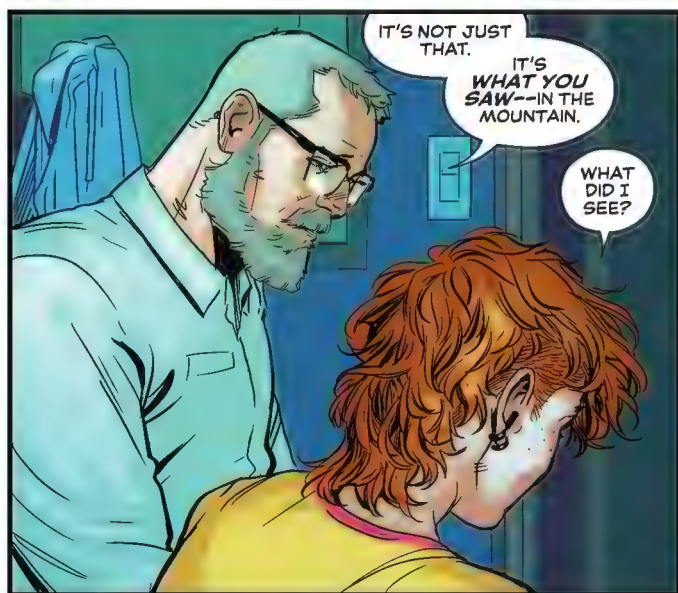
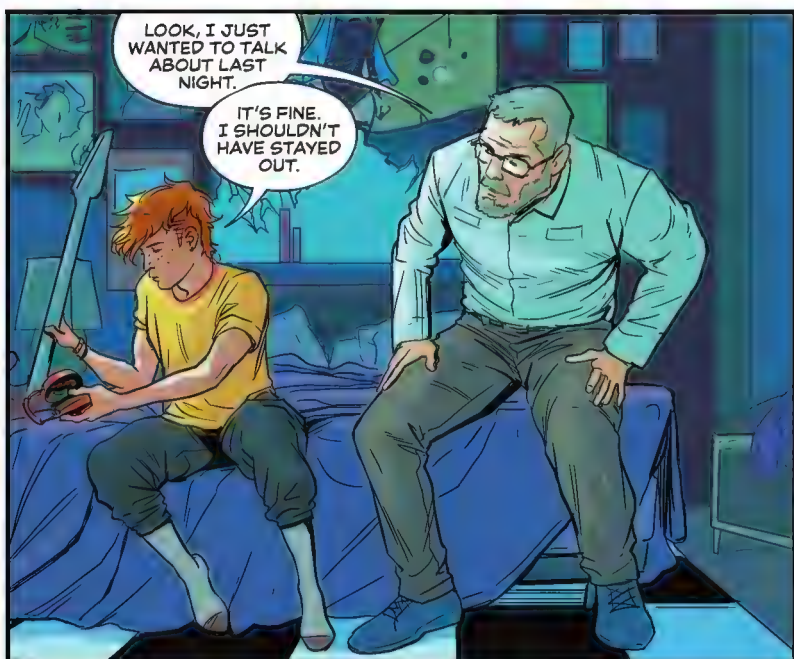
HARKNESS,
YOU I AM
GOING IN
HEAD-ON.

DEAD
OR ALIVE,
CAPTAIN?

ALIVE.

FOR
NOW.













WALLY?!

GET
AWAY,
SON!

GO!

RUN!

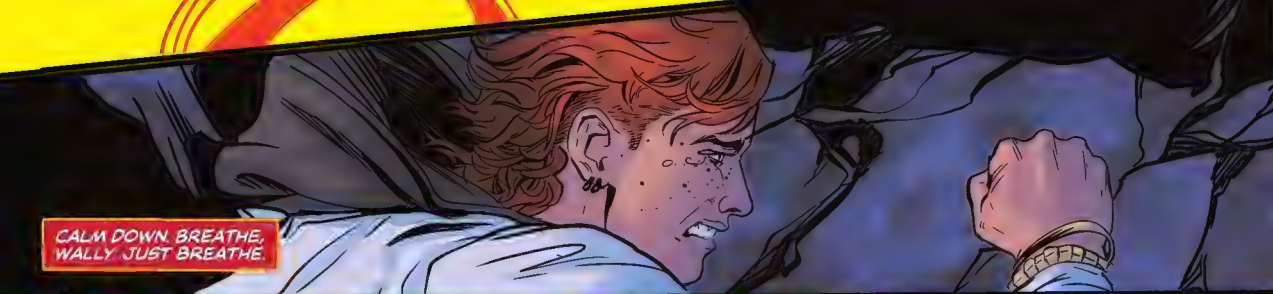


B--
BARRY?

RUN.

NOW





CALM DOWN. BREATHE.
WALLY JUST BREATHE.



NO! YOU'VE MESSED
EVERYTHING UP. THIS--THIS IS
ALL YOUR FAULT, WALLY. YOU
CAN RUN ALL YOU WANT. IT WILL
NEVER BE FAR ENOUGH.



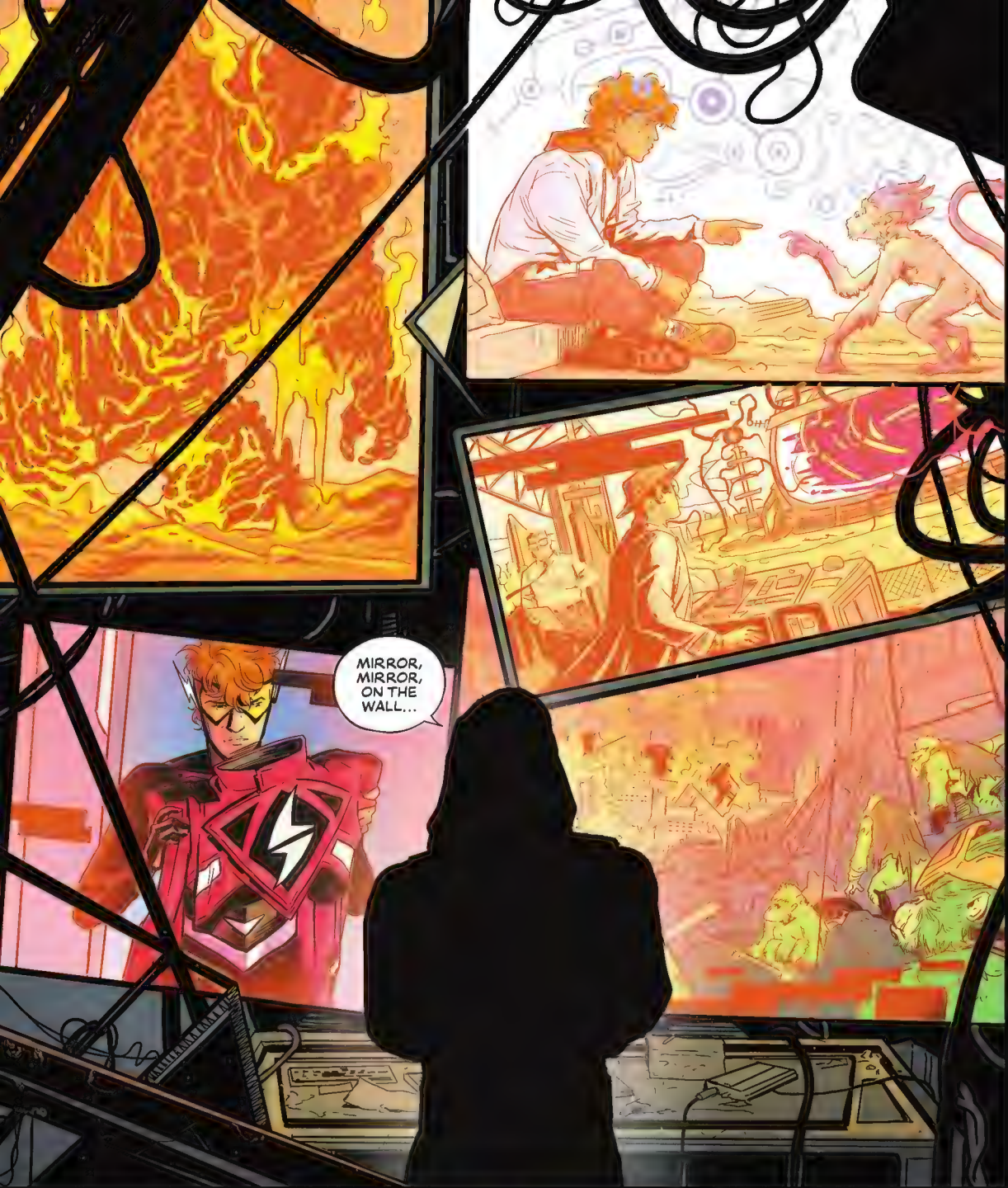
...YOU KNOW
WHAT YOU DID.

BARRY.

YOU DID THIS,
WALLY. YOU
KILLED HIM.

ALLEN BARRY





ABSOLUTE

MARTIAN MANHUNTER

#1 PREVIEW

WRITER **DENIZ CAMP**
ARTIST **JAVIER RODRIGUEZ**
LETTERS **HASSAN OTSMANE-ELHAOU**

YOU LOOK FOR
IDENTIFIABLE
PATTERNS.

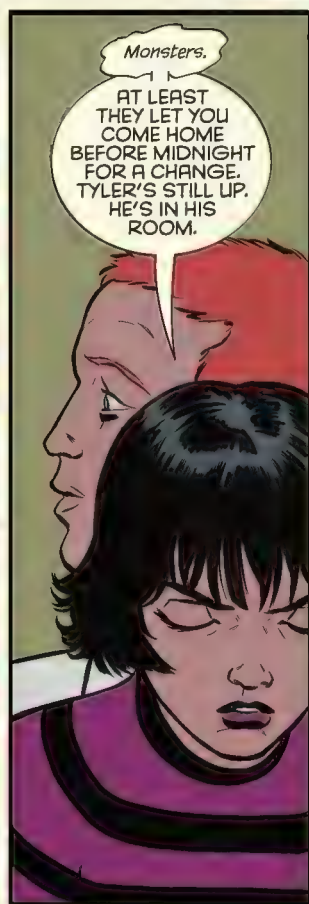
ANYTHING
TO MAKE THE
WORLD NOT
RANDOM.

THAT'S WHAT
STOCHASTIC
MEANS.

RANDOM.

(How do
I know?)

POOR,
TRAPPED
THINGS. LIGHT
THEMSELVES
ON FIRE TO
ESCAPE.







I STAY AWAKE ALL NIGHT, TRYING NOT TO THINK OF...

... OF THE SMOKE...

... OF WHAT'S WAITING FOR ME IN IT...



HAVE YOU EVER TRIED NOT TO THINK OF SOMETHING?



IT'S ALL YOU CAN THINK OF.

TO BE CONTINUED IN

ABSOLUTE
MARTIAN MANHUNTER #1

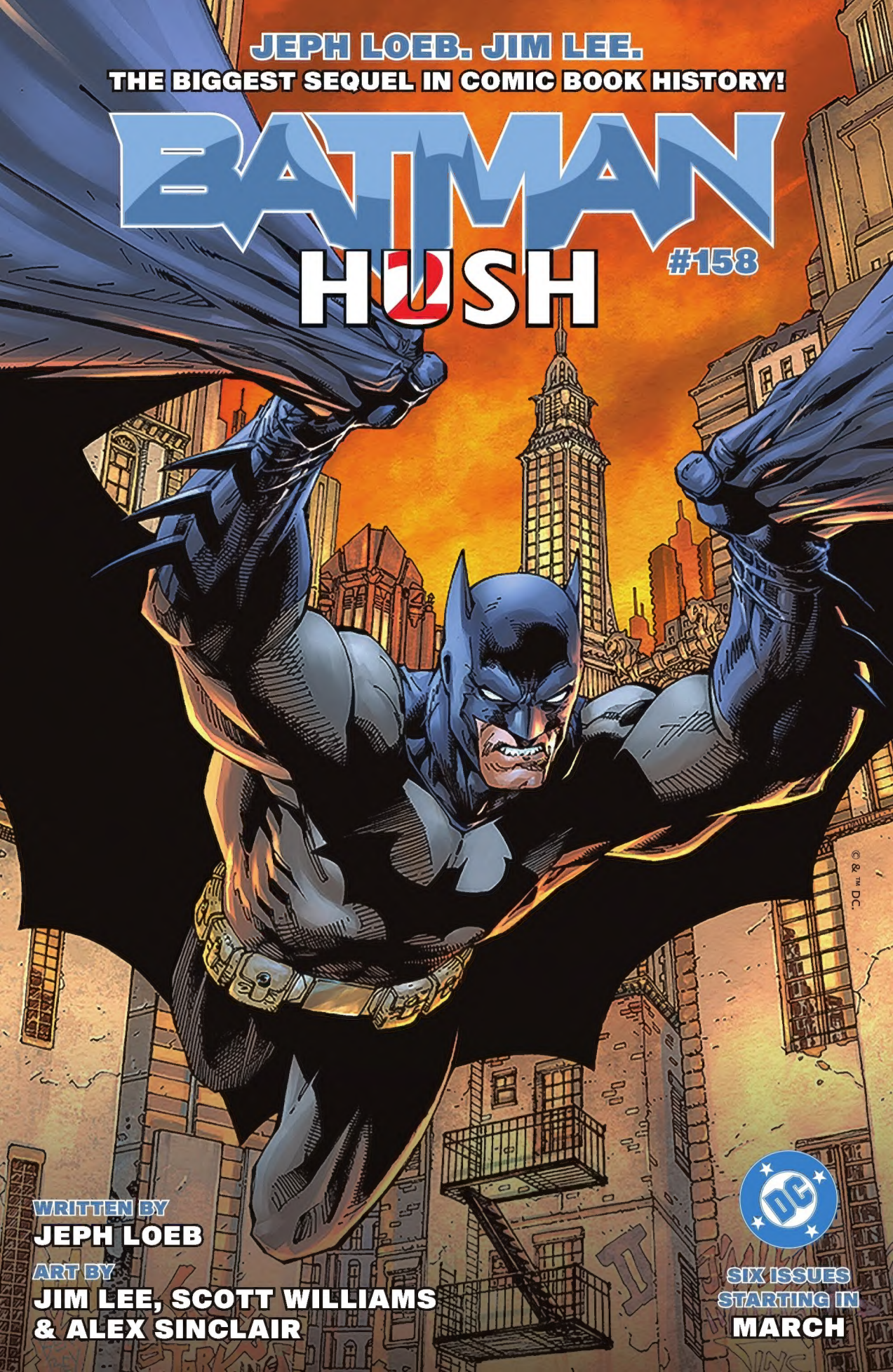
ON SALE IN MARCH!

JEPH LOEB. JIM LEE.
THE BIGGEST SEQUEL IN COMIC BOOK HISTORY!

BATMAN

HUSH

#158



WRITTEN BY
JEPH LOEB

ART BY
JIM LEE, SCOTT WILLIAMS
& ALEX SINCLAIR



SIX ISSUES
STARTING IN
MARCH

BATMAN HUSH

INTERVIEW WITH JEPH LOEB AND JIM LEE

For more than two decades, “Hush” by writer Jeph Loeb and artist Jim Lee has stood as one of the most popular and influential Batman stories of the 21st century. Now the comics superstars have reunited for a six-part sequel starting in *Batman* #158 and titled “H2SH,” with Hush, the titular villain introduced back in 2002, out for revenge against the Dark Knight.

Why was now the right time for “H2SH”?

Jim Lee: We’ve talked about coming back and doing a follow-up to “Hush” for a while. For a variety of reasons, the timing was never right. Because we’re doing the All In initiative, where we launched the Absolute line but still wanted crazy things to happen in the core line, it made this return to Hush the right opportunity.

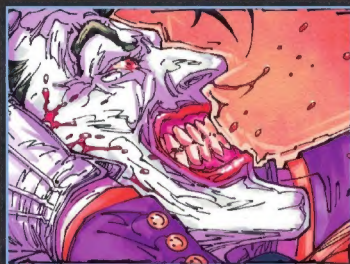
The challenge we had was, how do we recapture that excitement, yet do something new? Jeph, to his credit, crafted a story that feels very much like the opposite side of the coin to what he did 20 years ago. It establishes a new status quo for Batman, new villains, new looks, new locations.

Jeph Loeb: For 20 years, everywhere I’ve gone, people have asked me whether or not we’re going to do it again. My answer was always very honest: When Jim’s ready to go, I’ll be ready to go. I was in a little tiny airport in Italy, outside of Lucca; my phone rings, and Jim says, “I think it’s time for us to revisit these characters and to really come up with something that can not only build on what we did 20 years ago, but take it to the next level.” That was the challenge. Certainly artistically, I have no doubt in my mind that Jim, Scott [Williams], and Alex [Sinclair] outdid themselves.



How has Hush himself evolved between these two stories?

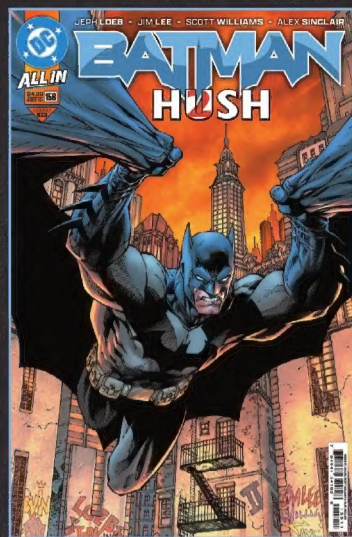
Loeb: So much of what we did in the first story was to play with, “Who is Hush? What does he want? What’s going on?” We’ve now established all that, so in many ways, this is a revenge story. He’s learned so much, and one of the great things about the character is that he’s a master manipulator. He likes the game of it. It’s like moving pieces on a chessboard. You don’t want to always play the same game. You want to take it in a new direction.



Jim, in what ways has your visual approach to these characters changed since the original “Hush”?

Lee: All the characters resemble the iconic versions of themselves, but we changed surface elements—melding the work that was done 20 years ago with the work we’re doing today.

We’re trying to do new kinds of shots, new angles, new color schemes. We’re challenging ourselves across the board, because we know there are high expectations. It’s also a great way to motivate ourselves, to do hopefully our best creative work.



DON’T MISS BATMAN #158, THE FIRST CHAPTER OF “H2SH,” ON SALE IN MARCH!

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